

Lord. One day Bud was in his office when he got a call from the president of the bank.

“Bud, could we have lunch tomorrow? I’d like to talk to you about your outstanding loans.”

“Sure,” Bud replied somewhat apprehensively. He imagined all kinds of things. Perhaps the bank had decided to sue him for collection. *But that doesn’t make any sense. I don’t have any assets to sell. We’re living in a rented house and driving an eight-year-old car. And, I’ve been making regular payments for years now.*

That evening Bud and Sandi, together with their children, prayed for God’s will in their lives, whatever that might be. Bud was able to go to sleep with the confidence that comes only from complete trust in God.

The next day at lunch Gary Cross, the bank president, said, “Bud, I want to thank you for living up to my confidence in you. I have to tell you that I had a dickens of a time convincing the other members of the board to go along with your plan. Some thought you were pulling a fast one on us. And others thought it would be better to get the whole thing over with and write off the bad debts. But your commitment and dependability to make a payment each month has been the subject of praise at several board meetings over the last two years.”

“Thank you, Gary. But I don’t think I deserve any praise for doing what is my responsibility anyway,” Bud replied honestly.

“Perhaps not, but I’ll tell you this: Not one other major debtor to the bank has repaid any of the bad syndicated loans. Most of them went bankrupt and put all their assets in someone else’s name. Doing what is right is not the norm today. We recently had a contract on the land you surrendered on your loans. Two days ago we sold the land, thus clearing your notes totally.”

“What?” Bud said breathlessly. “You mean that—oh man! Hey, I understand you didn’t have to do that. I’m just speechless.”

“But that’s not all,” the banker continued. “Our board wants you to come to work for us and manage our foreclosed properties. And